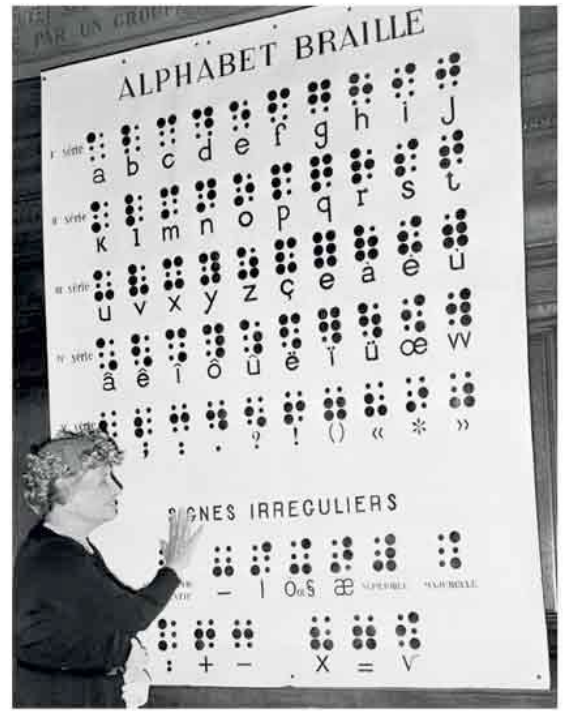


Louis Braille

Born in France in 1809, **LOUIS BRAILLE** was blinded in an accident when he was very young. At school, he wanted to read books, but there *weren't any for blind people*. When he went to a special school for blind children in Paris at the age of 10, there were books with raised letters that could be read by touch, but there were only a few, and they were **very hard to read**.



By the way...

At school, I heard about a special way of communicating that could be read in the dark, which inspired me to come up with my alphabet.

Louis Braille was blinded after an accident in his father's workshop when he was three.

Louis's alphabet

Braille was **DETERMINED** to find a better way to read. When he was just fifteen, he invented a system of **raised dots** arranged in rectangles, with different patterns for each letter. The Braille alphabet was simple to read and cheap to produce, and was soon **transforming lives**.

Braille

The key that unlocked the world of reading for **MILLIONS** of blind people

How it works

Nearly **200 years** after Braille came up with his alphabet, people are still using it, even with computers. Braille computer displays use **electromechanically** controlled pins to make Braille characters that can be touched. Research into how to make the Internet more accessible to blind people is underway, with Braille's alphabet **AT THE FRONT** of the new technology.

How it changed
Braille's system opened the doors of literature and education for blind people—making it easier for them to live a happy and full life.
the world

